কালীবাড়ি খবর

KALIBARI NEWS

(Registered Charity 1158269)
Visit us at: www.londonkalibari.org.uk

Kalibari Centre: 18 Byron Road, Wealdstone, Harrow, HA3 7ST
Issue 19, June 2018

From the Trustee Chairman

Dear Kalibari Members and Friends

Welcome to the June Newsletter. The last Newsletter was published two months ago in April, so only a few updates are provided in this edition.

From 25 May 2018 the new General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR) comes into force that gives individuals more control over the way their personal information is used. We need your consent so that London Kalibari can communicate with you about future events and progress on the Community Centre project. For this we have produced a Consent Form which some of you have already signed. If you have not done so please try to sign this form as soon as you can.

We are holding the 34th Annual General Meeting of London Kalibari on Sunday 22 July at 3 pm at the Kalibari Centre. Members will receive the Notice of the AGM from the Kalibari Secretary in due course. Supporters and friends are also invited to attend but only members who have registered for more than a year can vote.

We continue to look for a suitable permanent property. In the meantime we hold our regular activities in the current Kalibari Centre. Please join us whenever you can. I thank all the members who make regular monthly payments or make generous donations from time to time.

Bank of Baroda (London Kalibari Banker)
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General Secretary's Report:
On Sunday 13 May we celebrated Kalipujo at the Kalibari Centre, officiated by Amiya Bhattacharjya. Around seventy devotees attended which was higher than usual. We hope that this will be the norm from now on.

We held our first trustee meeting this year on Monday 26th March. We are always on the look out for a suitable property to establish our Kalibari, either the present one or something better. There are very few properties which have permission to hold community activities. We keep trying.

Our Annual General Meeting is planned on 22nd July. I shall write to you in due course with the relevant time and the agenda. Our next cultural function is on 7th July at Flash Musical hall. Look forward to seeing you all there.
Jai Ma Kali

Treasurer's Statement:
a) Income & Expenditure: (regular per month)

Income –	Standing Order	£240
	Lunch'n Club	£70*
	Donations	£30
	Hall Hire	£30
	Utsav/Events	£100
	Total	£470
Expenditure -	Rent	£500
	Utilities	£70
	Council Tax	£30 (Govt. Relief)
	Total	£600
Shortfall **		£130

* In the Luncheon club (every Monday), one member in turn donates the food and all contributions (nominally £3/head) from other members go to the fund
** Large donations make up the shortfall and leave a surplus for the Building Fund

b) We have a Building Fund. Some members contribute by monthly standing order and some members have made donations of £1000.
Please ask one of the Trustees if you wish to have further information.

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Cultural Secretary's Report

Here in Kalibari we aspire to reach out to our community. We aim to raise funds to build a community centre and a place of worship. So we organise socials and cultural events. I would just like to highlight some events so far this year.

Each Monday we hold a 'Lunch Club' at the Centre. Lunch is provided by attendees in rotation. We enjoy the food and the company and much needed funds are generated. Often we have external speakers. This year we had:

- Mr Peter Bradley from Rotary who spoke about the community project 'Food Cycle', a feeding programme for homeless people in the local area.
- Mr Arvind Patel who interested the gathering with his talk on Inheritance Tax.
- Sri Niharendu Bhattacharjee who chanted from the Gita, much to the delight of the devotees.

On 25 March Surajit Chakrabarti conducted Narayan Pujo. On 13 May Mr Amiya Bhattacharjee carried out New Moon Kalipujo. Both events were well attended. On 28 May Amiya Bhattacharjee conducted a 'Batsorik" in remembrance of his late wife Ruma. The solemn occasion was attended by his family and friends. Kalibari organised a well-attended cultural programme, Naboborsho / Rabindra Jayanti, at the Members Lounge, Harrow Civic Centre on 26 May. Performers included Kakoli Sengupta, Banani Poddar, Sandip Basu Mallick, Debabrata Dey, Sreeya Sengupta and Debasmitha Dey.

The upcoming fund raising cultural event is planned for 7th July at Flash Musical Theatre, Methuen Rd. Edgware. Several known artists will perform. Susmita Bhattacharya and Surojoy Bhowmik are providing great support for which we are most grateful. Please continue supporting us. We appreciate everything you do for our London Kalibari.

Jai Ma Kali.

Forthcoming Events 2018

1. Musical Evening - Saturday 7 July at Flash Musical, Methuen Road, Edgware, HA8 6EZ, free car parking in the streets (further information coming soon)
2. New Moon Kali Pujo on 26th August at Kalibari Centre.
3. Main Kalipuja – Tuesday 6 November at Harrow Arts Centre, 6.00pm to 11pm, free car parking

Every Monday – Luncheon Club from 1pm to 4pm

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London Kalibari wishes to thank the following:

1. London Kalibari Life Members.
2. Supporters and helpers from the Community.
3. Harrow Council for Accommodation and Rate Support.
4. Harrow Art Centre for Diwali/Kalipuja.
5. Recent large contributors (above £500 and giving by Standing Order).
6. Mr Navin Shah, GLA Member, Wealdstone Labour Hall, for arranging the rental of the Kalibari Centre.
7. Mr Gareth Thomas, MP for Harrow West, Labour Party for his support.
8. Councillors of Harrow Council for their support and encouragement.
9. Sponsors of Kalibari events & activities.
10. Ms Tanuka Saha, of N. Saha & Co. Chartered Accountants
11. Our local artists, Arijit Chakravarty and Debabrata Dey
12. Mrs Kakali Sengupta (Paris) for music
13. Mr Avishek Chaudhuri for website

Please note: Our intention is that when we have acquired a permanent centre, all contributions will be acknowledged, and those contributing significant amounts will be specially named (such as on a board or on a plaque).

Donations: Please make cheques payable to London Kalibari and send them to 13 Kenton Gardens, Harrow, Middlesex, HA3 8DE. For donations by Standing Orders, please contact the Treasurer, Mrinal Choudhury.

Trustees:
Dr Sudin Mandal (Chair), Mrs Jayati Das (Secretary), Mr Mrinal Choudhury (Treasurer), Mrs Krishna Ghosh, Mrs Debjani Sengupta and Dr Satya Chatterjee.

Core Support Group
Mrs Rama Choudhury, Mrs Gita Dutta, Mr Ajit Ghosh, Mrs Babli Mazumdar, Mr Kanu Roy, Mr Snehangshu Basu, Mrs Giti Ray and Mrs Dipti Chatterjee.

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কলকাতা-কলকাতা-কলকাতা

আরতি রুবি ঠাকুর(ক্যালিফোর্নিয়া)

পঞ্চাশ বছরের ওপরে ছেড়ে এসেছি আমার কলকাতাকে কিন্তু দুরে সরে যেতে পারিনি কখনই। প্রায় তিনভাগ পৃথিবী ঘোরা হয়ে গেছে কিন্তু সেইসব শহরে তো আবার ঘুরে যেতে ইচ্ছে হয় না- শুধু কলকাতাই আমাকে চুম্বকের মতো টানে কেনো সবসময়ে? দুষিত -বাতাস খোলা নর্দমা মশা-মাছি সবই যেনো উপেক্ষার মধ্যে পরে যায়।কলকাতার আনাচে কানাচে ছড়িয়ে আছে অজস্র ইমারত - কোনোটির গায়ে কালের ক্ষত - কোনোটি অতীতের মুহুর্তের মিনার।তার মধ্যে মধ্যেই অত্যাধুনিক বহুতল ফ্ল্যাট গজিয়ে উঠেছে। পাশেই হয়তো বস্তি -তার পাশ দিয়ে আধুনিক তরুণীরা- জিন্স আর ট্যাংকটপ এ সজ্জিত হয়ে চলেছেন - কফি হাউসের আড্ডা পেড়িয়ে - বারিস্তা -পাঁচতলের কফি সপে।আমার দেখতে ভালোই লাগে।সময় পাল্টায়-নজর-পাল্টায় নগর পাল্টায় -এইসব পুরানো/নতুনের জরাজরি দেখতে খুব ভালোবাসি।

এটা আমার মনের শহর- প্রাণের শহর -আমার শহর কলকাতা।

চারটি অক্ষরের নামের জাদু যে আচ্ছন্ন করে রাখে মন। আমেরিকাও চারটি অক্ষর কিন্তু সেই জাদুর ছোঁয়া পাইনা কেনো। আমেরিকা-ইংল্যান্ড থেকেছি তিপান্ন বছর-দেশে মাত্র আঠারো বছর। আমেরিকা আমাকে অনেক দিয়েছে - আমি কৃতজ্ঞ কিন্তু কোথায় আবার জন্মাতে চাই জানিতে চাইলে-বলবো কলকাতা। ছোটো বয়সে বুঝিনি আজ বুঝি - ''এমন দেশটি কোথাও খুজে পাবে নাকো তুমি -সে যে সকল দেশের রানী - সে যে আমার জন্মভুমি''। উনি কি দেশ বলতে ভারত কে বুঝিয়েছিলেন - না বাংলাকে? আমি আমার দেশ বলতে যাকে দেখি - সে বাংলা। বেশির ভাগ লোকেই দেশ কে ''মা'' বলে সম্বোধন করেন কিন্তু আমার দেশকে - আমার সন্তান মনে হয়। মা তো অবিচল/একই রকম থাকেন। তিনি সন্তানের সাফল্য/পরিবর্তন চোখ ভরে দেখেন। বিভিন্ন সময়ে তার উত্থান/পতন-নতুন রুপের বিকাশ দেখে মা ই সুখী হতে পারেন- তার ভালো সব সময়তেই চেয়ে থাকেন। তার সন্তান যতই কুৎসিত হোক না কেনো- মায়ের চোখে কিন্তু সে -পৃথিবীতে সবথেকে সুন্দর ।

মা -নিজের সন্তানের দোষ হয়তো দেখতে পান কিন্তু অন্য কেউ সেই দোষটা ধড়িয়ে দিলে-তার রাগ হয়। এই অনুভুতিটা আমার মধ্যে হয়। গোটা পশ্চিমবঙ্গকেই-আমার বড় নিজের মনে হয় -সন্তান ভাবি।

কলকাতার রাস্তায় ভিড়- গোড়িয়াহাটের মোড়- শ্যামবাজারের পাঁচ মাথার মোড়- সারপেন্টাইন লেনের সেই সরুগলি- এসব আমার বড়একান্ত বড় নিজের মনে হয়।

পাশের গ্রামের তারাভরা আকাশ যে আশ্রয় দেয়- তা সানফ্রানসিস্কোর আলোর রোসনাই- দিতে পারে না - চোখ ধাঁধাতে পারে। কলকাতার সাথে একত্বতা-অনেকটা বিনি সুতোর গাঁথা মালার মতো। নিজেদের স্বার্থে এই কলকাতা পেছনে ফেলে চলে এসেছি বহুকাল আগে।

অনেক কষ্ট-কৃচ্ছ সাধন করতে হয়েছে - পা ফেলায় মাটিটা বড্ড নরম ছিলো। লালন করা স্বপ্ন-বাস্তব হবার পর,সেই বাস্তবকেও যে পালন করতে হয়েছে। তখন একটা আগুন ছিলো ভিতরে। কে যেনো বলেছিলো-''ভেতরে আগুন থাকলে-মানুষ অনেক দুর যেতে পারে-শুধু আ-গুনের রোয়াব দেখলে -খুব দ্রুত

Ms Tanuka Saha
N. Saha & Co., Chartered Accountants, 133 The Broadway,
Mill Hill, London NW7 4RN (London Kalibari Accountant)

www.nsaha.co.uk Telephone 020 8906 8855

(continued from page 5)

সেই আগুন-নিজেকে জ্বালাবে-অন্যকে তাপ দেবে।''সব থেকে ভালো যে ইস্পাত, তাকে-সব থেকে গরম আগুনের মধ্যে দিয়ে বেরিয়ে আসতে হয়। এদেশে সেদেশে ঘুরে বেড়াই এই বয়সেও। কোথাও আর বেশিদিন ভালো লাগেনা। পালাতে পারলে-বেশ একটা মুক্তির আনন্দ হয়-এমনকি-
সে পালানো-জলন্ত পাত্র থেকে খোদ আগুনের মধ্যে হলেও। স্বামীর ওপরে অনেক ভরসা করে জীবন চালাতাম- সে আজ নেই -ভরসা করার লোকও নেই।
যখন কেউ পরের ওপরে ভরসার সেতুগুলো নিজেই পুরিয়ে দেয়, সে আগুনের তাপ-স্বনির্ভরতা এনে দেয়। যেখানেই যাই-সবাইকেই আমার বন্ধু মনে হয়-তবে কিন্তু আমার সন্তান ''কলকাতার'' মতো বন্ধু আর কোথাও মিললো না। দেখি ওপারে কি অপেক্ষা করছে।

(Author's apologies for a few typing errors)

Community Corner

Swami Vivekananda Statue In Harrow (Update).

We are very pleased to report that on 6 June Harrow Council granted planning permission to erect a statue of Swami Vivekananda in front of the Dance Studio of Harrow Arts Centre.

Originally the plan was to use Marble dust and chemical for the statue but the permission specifies the use Portland Stone instead. Because of the use of Portland Stone, the cost will be higher than the original estimate of between £10,000 and £15,000. It is hoped to unveil the statue in August / September 2018. Please donate to the fund by contacting Mrinal Choudhury, 020 8907 5946

Mr Bidhan Bose

We regret to report the death of Bidhan Bose in January 2018. He was born in April 1928 and came to the UK in May 1957. He very quickly became involved in many organisations associated with the Bengali diaspora, whether it was amateur dramatics, cultural events, Durga Puja or raising money for various good causes. And thus he became well known within the Bengali community.

He was involved with London Kalibari from its inception. On a Sunday afternoon, after dance classes, at Krishna Ghosh's house, some of the parents stayed behind to have a chat over a few cups of tea and "ta". One of the topics, during one of these sessions was the idea of establishing a "Kali Bari" in London. Krishna was very excited about the prospect and Bidhan supported this wholeheartedly and was quick to get involved. Before long, a venue was selected, which Bidhan arranged at the Hindu Centre and the first Kali Puja took place there. He leaves behind his wife Meera, daughters Debi and Rini and family.

Community Corner (continued)

Mrs Purabi Aich

Purabi Aich, a life member, died in April 2018. A Shraddha was performed in her house by her son Parag on 4 May 2018. We send our sincere condolences to her family.

London Kalibari Community Centre Project

London Kalibari is an organisation representing the Hindu Bengalee Community in the UK. It is an organisation with a constitution and is a charity registered in 1982 and converted into a Charitable Incorporated Organisation (CIO) in 2014. It has raised funds for the Community Centre Project through many social and cultural activities.

Our aim is to establish a permanent Community Centre in which social, cultural and spiritual activities can be held regularly. In the meantime, we have acquired a leased accommodation at **18 Byron Road, Harrow, Wealdstone, HA3 7ST**, with a main hall, two smaller rooms, kitchen and two toilets. The Centre is used for social and religious activities including a Luncheon Club on Mondays between 1pm and 4pm. A suitable larger property is estimated to cost around £1Million. A smaller property of the sort we are currently using will cost up to £500,000 with suitable alterations. We are looking to purchase the current site but no offer of sale has yet been made – we are continuing to pursue this. If we were to move to a different site, the main problem is to get permission to hold large community activities. Also, significant monies will have to be raised from the community. London Kalibari has a Building Fund and a number of members have donated £1,000 each and larger pledges have also been made. We hope you can support us in this worthy cause.

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Associated Organisations:

Sri Aurobindo Society (UK)
A Regd Charity. Address: 149 Eastcote Lane, South Harrow, HA2 8RR. On Saturdays and Sundays it is open for meditation from 6.00pm to 7.00pm. Telephone: 020 8422 9920

International Society for Krishna Consciousness (ISKCON)
Hare Krishna Temple (Watford), Bhaktivedanta Manor, Dharam Marg, Hilfield Lane, Aldenham, Herts, WD25 8DT. Website: www.krishnatemple.com, Contact 01923 851000

Ramkrishna Vedenta Centra
A Regd Charity, situated in Bourn End at Blind Lane, Buckinghamshire, SL8 5LG. The centre can be accessed from M40, either Exit 3 or Exit 4. Tel: 016285 26464

Nrityakala Dance Heritage
Non profit making voluntary organisation. Address: 15 Southway, Totteridge, London N20 8EB. Phone: 797 3290373, website: www.nrityakala.org

Aid India Forum
Reg Charity No. 262210
Helping social and educational projects in India**.** Contact telephone 020 8907 5946

Gaudiya Misson (UK)
A Regd Charity Address:27 Cranhurst Road, London NW2 4LJ (near Willesden Green Tube) Contact : www.gaudiyamission.com, Tel 020 8452 2733

Auro Mira Centre
126 Whiting Avenue East, Greenford, UB6 0PY
Mr Sanjib Manek, M: 07867 792369

Vivekananda Human Centre
Vivekananda House, 2a Elmhurst Drive, South Woodford, London E18 1BT.
Tel: 020 8989 9927 and 020 7702 4100

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